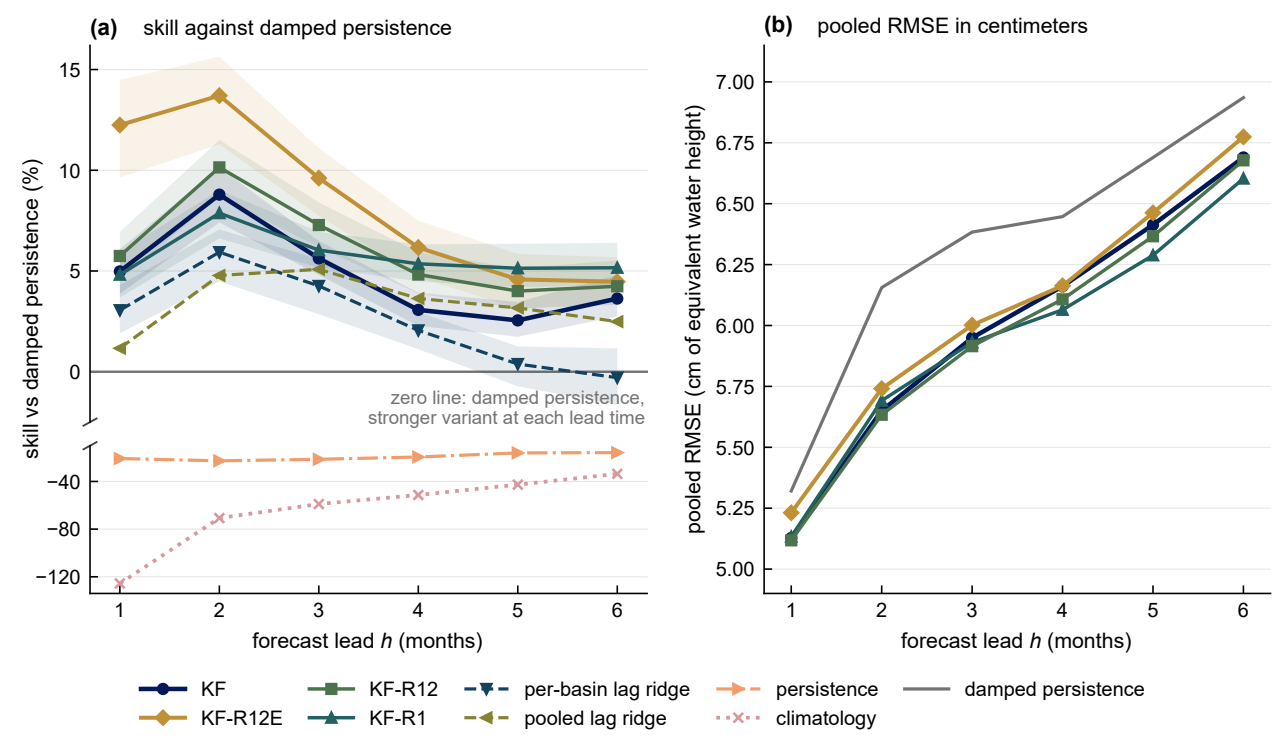

(a) skill against damped persistence
skill vs damped persistence (%)
15
10
5
0
−40
−80
−120
zero line: damped persistence,
stronger variant at each lead time
1
2
3
4
5
6
forecast lead h (months)
(b) pooled RMSE in centimeters
pooled RMSE (cm of equivalent water height)
7.00
6.75
6.50
6.25
6.00
5.75
5.50
5.25
5.00
forecast lead h (months)
KF
KF-R12E
KF-R12
KF-R1
per-basin lag ridge
pooled lag ridge
persistence
climatology
damped persistence